

Stories of Research and Education under Israeli Occupation

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Palestine

Content

- The story of my research lab
- Challenges facing us
- Ways to help us

 SinaLab

NewsTeamResources

مختبر سينا لحوسبة اللغة والذكاء الاصطناعي

SinaLab for Computational Linguistics and Artificial Intelligence

Welcome to SinaLab, a research laboratory at Birzeit University. Our research interests include Arabic Natural Language Processing and Understanding, Arabic dialects, Machine Learning, Knowledge Graphs, Ontology Engineering, Data Engineering, and Interoperability and e-governance.

We are passionate about developing open-source lexicographic databases, datasets, annotated corpora, and NLP tools.

We named our lab after Ibn Sina (Avicenna), one of the most influential philosophers who acknowledged the link between logic and language (1).

News



Bin Rashid's Arabic Language Award



Shoman Arab Researchers Award



Top 30 Arab AI Experts by MIT Technology Review



Six Arabic Dialects Corpora Released

Resources and Downloads



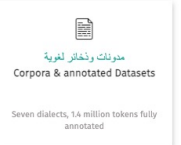
الأطولوجيا العربية
Arabic Ontology / Wordnet

Formal Arabic Wordnet, 17k concepts/synsets



قواعد بيانات معجمية
Lexicons & Lexicographic Databases

150 Multilingual lexicons (translations, synonyms, glosses)



مجموعات ونماذج لغوية
Corpora & annotated Datasets

Seven dialects, 1.4 million tokens fully annotated



أدوات وبرمجيات
NLP Tools

NER, WSD, synonyms, lemmatizers, POS tagger, etc.

[More Resources](#)

Team



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Lab Director



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Sanad Malaysha



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Alaa Aljabari

Address:
Birzeit University

News
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Projects

Arabic Ontology
Arabic Lexicons
Currasat





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Resource Limitations

No Research Funding programs

Palestine is an authority (not a state) and has no financial resources.



Difficult for universities to maintain adequate funding for research.

Very limited access to academic journals, books, and resources, GPUs, data ...

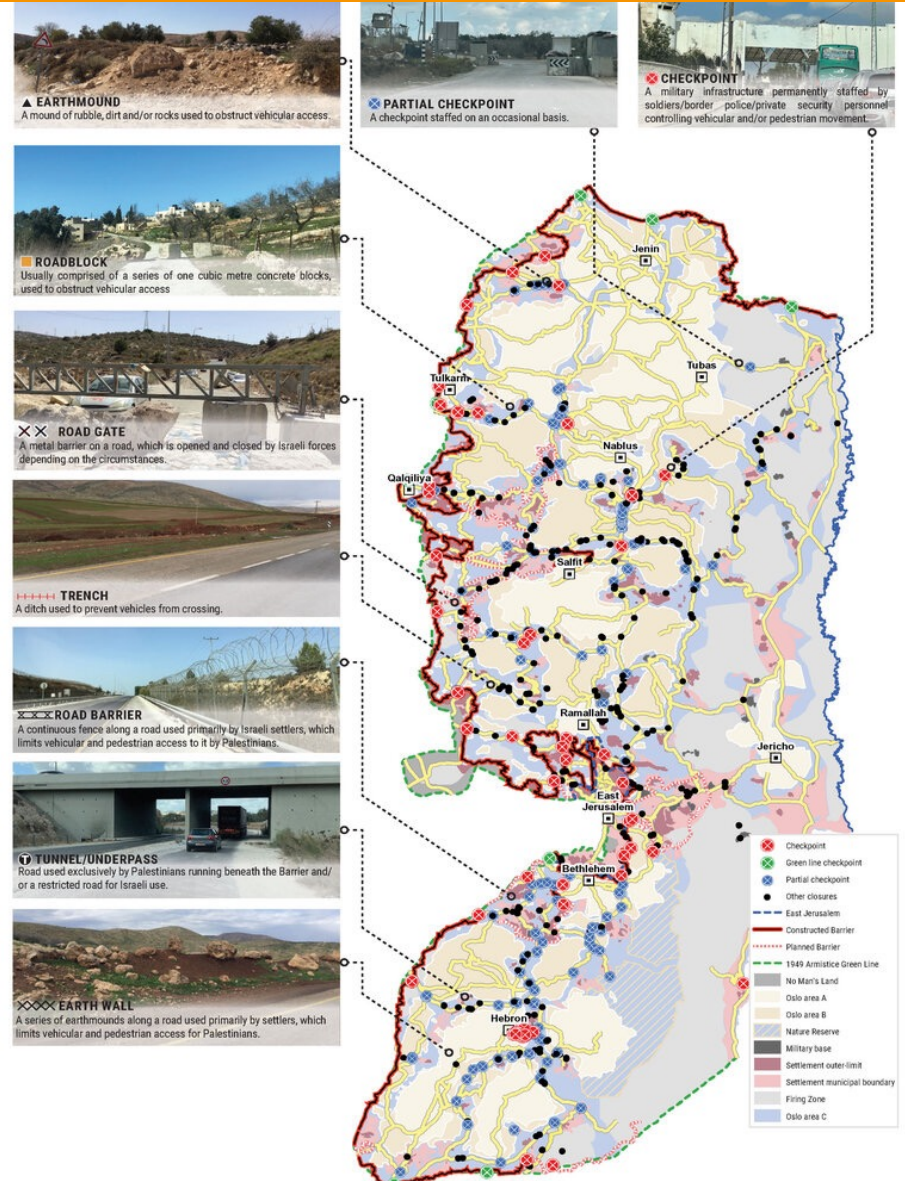
No funding to travel conferences

Restrictions on Movement



- Students and researchers are often delayed by checkpoints and roadblocks.
- Leave home very early, and come back very late (very disturbing)!
- Disrupts educational schedules

Restrictions on Movement



When traveling for conferences and meetings



- travel to Jordan/Egypt and fly from there (mostly closed,).
- Extra time! extra cost! Extra security checks and humiliation!

Impact not only on Palestinian scientists,
but others avoid partnering with us!

Academic Freedom

الحرية الأكاديمية

- **limitations** by Israel, on research topics, publications, and expressing opinions.
- **Academic Bias**, in some academic journals and communities.



The academic institutions allege these actions are part of a draconian campaign, which has been in effect since the occupation of the West Bank and Gaza.

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The Ministry of Education, Yoav Kish, has announced that it is monitoring 89 cases and procedures against Palestinian students, of which subsequently led to the suspension of some students.



Academic Brain Drain

هجرة العلماء

Academics are pushed to leave (especially in Gaza)
weakening the local research and
education sector.



Eduicide in Gaza

deliberately targeting universities and academics in Gaza

killed

5,479 students

261 teachers

95 university professors,

3 university presidents

injured

7,819 students

756 teachers

Destroyed:

195 Heritage sites

227 Mosques

3 churches

60% educational facilities (all/17 universities,

80% of schools in Gaza)

625,000 students have no access to education

How to help Palestinian Academia

كيف تدعم الأكاديمية في فلسطين

Priority to Gaza and Jerusalem

In many ways, such as:

- Advocacy and awareness
- Combat discrimination and Bias
- Resources and Funding
- Open Access Publications
- Joint research projects
- Cash to students/universities

Joint PhD supervision

Promote Palestinian researchers

Invite us to chair events

Scholarships and Exchanges

Research visits

Teaching visits

**Supporting and cooperating with Palestinians is good
they are Passionate, Smart and hardworking ;-)**

Thank You